

Plectis

Research with AI, mathematics and software

WILL COOK · SEPTEMBER 2026

I built Plectis to pursue research I found interesting with AI, and to make a back-and-forth with human experts possible. I choose a direction, work at it and prepare the results for someone who can interpret them. Their feedback changes the next direction; I work on that and return, [recording their contribution and where later work builds on it](#)¹. An expert should be able to shape the research without having to operate the AI.

I have time and prompting experience, but limited mathematical knowledge. I chose mathematics because formal proofs can be checked, while interpretation and significance still require judgement. That lets me explore how far I can get, where I need help, and how those boundaries change as models improve.

The [Navier–Stokes announcement](#)² makes the question more immediate. If comparable capabilities reach inexpensive open models, output could exceed what experts can examine. [Tao and his co-signatories](#)³ distinguish solving problems from developing understanding. I think mathematics needs a floor for AI-assisted submissions: intelligible arguments, appropriate checks, clear limitations and attribution. Meeting it should make engagement easier, not create an entitlement to review. Experts can favour well-prepared work, giving producers an incentive to reduce the burden they impose.

The [mathematics repository](#)⁴ prototypes that floor around eight deliberately difficult Erdős problems. At [#257](#), a Lean-checked finite-prime weighted condition at base two proves that every infinite subset of a qualifying support has an irrational reciprocal-Mersenne sum at every integer base $b \geq 2$. The paper constructs qualifying supports with divergent ordinary reciprocal mass; the universal question remains open. The repository also checks aní’s degree-seven example against both total variation and the [Formal Conjectures path-image Hausdorff-length statement](#): for this one polynomial, the image of every path joining distinct roots inside the strict lemniscate has one-dimensional Hausdorff measure greater than two. Whether this matches the historical curve-length question still needs independent review. The other seven targets remain open. Its [problem pages](#) join partial results, computations, Lean proofs and Comparator checks of selected statements. Short papers introduce the mathematics; longer records retain the reasoning for researchers and agents. At [#251](#), constructed sequences expose a limit of prime-gap analogies. A [renderer fix](#)⁵ landed upstream in Palomar. I have prioritised exposition and intermediate results over formalising every claim.

Nineteenth-century mariners [contributed observations and received improved sailing charts](#)⁶, so each voyage benefited from earlier ones. Plectis follows that cumulative pattern: failed routes stay beside successful lemmas with their conditions and limits, ready for another researcher or model to reinterpret.

The [website](#) is the human wrapper. Its [mathematics map](#) connects questions, claims, papers and formal source; the [glossary](#) explains terminology. A downloadable [source brief](#) lets readers explore with their own assistant. Agents help prepare these views from the underlying work. I want increasing intelligence applied to making complexity manageable, not just producing more of it. The system is deliberately broad, which makes signal to noise the central problem; the front end is where I work on how presentation adapts to that breadth. As AI raises what a back end can do, the front end has to rise with it, so that understanding and auditability scale with capability.

The [safety doctrine](#) sets out axioms, principles and anti-principles; checks and permissions enforce particular rules. My [June questions](#) ask how model capability, operating environments and independent scrutiny interact. The [systems](#) and [archived open-source](#) papers explain how people can contribute direction, review, exposition, software or compute. The back-and-forth still needs testing with independent collaborators. My aim is for improving AI to multiply what an expert can direct and understand, rather than multiply the output waiting in their inbox.

SOURCES

- 1 Plectis, credit policy, docs/research-commons/CREDIT_POLICY.md in the mathematics repository.
https://github.com/wcook04/plectis-erdos/blob/main/docs/research-commons/CREDIT_POLICY.md
- 2 OpenAI, *On the Navier–Stokes Millennium Prize Problem*. <https://openai.com/index/navier-stokes-solution/>
- 3 T. Tao and co-signatories, *A severe misalignment of AI in mathematics*, 11 September 2026.
<https://terrytao.wordpress.com/2026/09/11/a-severe-misalignment-of-ai-in-mathematics/>
- 4 Plectis mathematics repository. <https://github.com/wcook04/plectis-erdos>
- 5 PalomarSubmission, pull request 137. <https://github.com/PalomarRegistry/PalomarSubmission/pull/137>
- 6 *The Origin and Work of the Division of Marine Meteorology*, Hydrographic Office, U.S. Naval Institute Proceedings 19/3, July 1893.
<https://www.usni.org/magazines/proceedings/1893/july/origin-and-work-division-marine-meteorology-hydrographic-office>